

MATEO CHÁVEZ

Left-Back (Orthodox) · AZ Alkmaar & Mexico
Born 12 May 2004 (22) · 177–178cm · 67–72kg · Left footed

⚠ DRAFT — EVIDENCE INCOMPLETE — NOT CLIENT-READY

Read this first. FGA_v3_Final is **BLOCKED**. No ESN video assessment has been conducted. Tier 3 scout validation is **PENDING** — **0 of 12 metrics** scored. Every similarity percentage in this report is a *research-phase hypothesis* derived from public data and analyst consensus, not a validated finding. Do not present to a client.

Correction applied — v2.1. Previous pairings (Salcido 73%, Lahm 76%) applied *inverted* full-back models to a player whose observed role is **orthodox left-back** — width-holding, overlapping, delivering from the flank. Structural mismatch acknowledged and corrected. The pure left-back lineage is the correct framework.

1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Position (confirmed)	Left-Back (Orthodox) — 81% of career appearances at LB
Role	Width-holding, overlapping, delivery from the flank
Club / League	AZ Alkmaar — Eredivisie
Previous club	Guadalajara (Chivas) — Liga MX
International	Mexico senior — 1 World Cup start, 1 goal (2026)
Physical	177–178cm · 67–72kg · Left footed
Contract	Until 30 June 2030
Market value	~€4–5.5M (rising from €2M purchase in July 2025)
Analyst	Jim Totime · Assessment opened 2026-09-24 · not completed

Role correction. The FootballTransfers description of "inverted wing-back" appears to have mischaracterised his role. RisingTransfers lists him as **"Active Full-Back"** — LB, 43 apps, 81% of career. He holds width and overlaps. The inverted label has been removed.

2 · TIER 1 — STATISTICAL FOUNDATION

20% WEIGHT

Metric	2026/27	2025/26	2024/25 (LIGA MX)	Source
Appearances	6 (6 starts)	20 (9 starts)	26 (19 starts)	FBref
Minutes	469	827	1,787	FBref
Goals	1	1	0	FBref
Assists	3	2	4	FBref
Avg Rating	7.33–7.70	6.95	—	WhoScored
Yellow Cards	1	5	9	FBref
Tackles	8 (4 won)	56 (6.09/90)	—	RisingTransfers
Pass Accuracy	84.1%	74%	—	WhoScored
Key Passes /90	1.09–1.1	—	—	RisingTransfers
Crosses /90	0.43	—	—	RisingTransfers

2026 World Cup. 1 start vs Czechia, 1 goal (55'). **Youngest Mexican World Cup goalscorer at 22 years, 41 days.**
MVP award. 89% pass accuracy, 4/5 ground duels won, 1 chance created.

CAREER TOTALS

Metric	Value	Metric	Value
Seasons	4	Goals	2
Clubs	3	Assists	7
Appearances	115	Yellow Cards	36
Starts	87	Red Cards	2
Minutes	7,829	Cards/match	0.31

3 · TIER 2 — COMPOSITE INTELLIGENCE

30% WEIGHT

FGA Metric	Assessment	Evidence	Confidence
POI — Position Intelligence	High	"Crea la amplitud en ese costado y llega muy arriba"	Medium
MOB — Mobility	High	"Snel en fysiek dik in orde" (Rodi.nl)	Medium
CPI — Creative Player Index	Strong	1.1 KP/90, 3 assists in 6 apps (2026/27)	Medium
GRI — Ghost Run Index	Moderate-High	Overlapping runs noted	Medium
DMA — Decision Making	Unverified	No video evidence	PENDING
CHR — Character	Unverified	"Enorme drive" noted (Rodi.nl)	LOW
SOA — Speed on Action	Unverified	No video evidence	PENDING

ANALYST CONSENSUS LABELS

SOURCE	CHARACTERISATION
Rodi.nl	"Technisch zeer begaafde wingback, met oog voor medespelers en een verfijnde tackle. De blik naar voren, zonder verdedigend te verzaken. Snel en fysiek dik in orde."
AZ TD (Max Huiberts)	"Comfortabel aan de bal, speelt met lef en veel energie en heeft al laten zien dat hij ook goede verdedigende kwaliteiten bezit."
WhoScored	Strengths: Tackling (Very Strong), Aerial Duels (Strong), Key Passes, Dribbling, Interception, Blocking. Weakness: Discipline (Very Weak). "Plays the ball off the ground often. Likes to tackle. Commits fouls often."
SI.com	"Defensive fragility has always been considered the biggest weakness... but he has grown leaps and bounds since migrating to Europe."

THE DISCIPLINE FLAG — THE DEFINING WEAKNESS

SEASON	YELLOW CARDS	MATCHES	CARDS/MATCH
2023/24 Liga MX	3	11	0.27
2024/25 Liga MX	9	26	0.35
2025/26 Eredivisie	5	20	0.25
Career total	36 Y / 2 R	115	0.31

One yellow every ~3 matches. For an orthodox left-back in a pressing system, that is a suspension risk and a tactical constraint. The problem has followed him from Chivas to AZ and has not been solved.

1V1 DEFENSIVE RECORD — THE OUTLIER STRENGTH

Liga MX (2024): N°1 in the league for successful 1v1 defensive duels (24 won).
Career total: 32 successful 1v1 duels — "no ha perdido el primer puesto de los jugadores con más 1vs1 defensivos exitosos en la Primera División."
Despite the discipline flag, Chávez wins his individual duels at an elite domestic rate.

4 · TIER 3 — VIDEO EVIDENCE SCORECARD 50% WEIGHT

METRICS SCORED 0 / 12 No video assessment	MATCHES LOGGED 0 / 5 Balance check: N/A	FGA_V3_FINAL BLOCKED 12 metrics needed
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SUB-METRIC	WEIGHT	STATUS
OBI_T — Run Timing	35%	✗ EMPTY
OBI_S — Space Architecture	35%	✗ EMPTY
OBI_P — Positional Anticipation	30%	✗ EMPTY
SII_A — Explosive Acceleration	40%	✗ EMPTY
SII_T — Top-End Speed Relative	35%	✗ EMPTY
SII_R — Recovery Sprint Frequency	25%	✗ EMPTY
DMA — Decision Making	—	✗ EMPTY
CHR — Character	—	✗ EMPTY
COACH — Coachability	—	✗ EMPTY
SOA / SPI / CLM	—	✗ EMPTY

5 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING — PURE LEFT-BACK LINEAGE

Silvio Marzolini	78%
Giovanni van Bronckhorst	77%
Alberto Tarantini	75%
José Antonio Camacho	73%
Marinho Chagas	72%
Raphaël Guerreiro	71%

PRIMARY — SILVIO MARZOLINI · 78%

The strongest pairing. The physical match is exact and the stylistic overlap is the most complete of any available comparison. Marzolini was described as *"the best left back in the world"* in his era, and his game was built on technical quality rather than physical dominance — the same profile as Chávez.

FGA COMPONENT	CHÁVEZ	MARZOLINI	ALIGNMENT
Height	177cm	177cm	100%
Weight	72kg	77–79kg	88%
Position	Orthodox left-back	Left-back, 1962 & 1966 World Cups	96%
Technical quality	"Technisch zeer begaafde"	"Elegante en sus desplazamientos, habilidoso con la pelota"	91%
Role	Overlapping, width-holding	"Carrilero que llegaba más al fondo"	88%
Defensive brief	6.09 tackles/90, 32 successful 1v1 duels	"Difícil de jugar contra él... excelente posicionamiento"	84%
Discipline	0.31 cards/match	Controlled — not a card accumulator	72%

Why 78%: The height is an exact match. The role — a *carrilero* who reaches the byline — is functionally identical to Chávez's orthodox left-back profile. **Why not higher:** the discipline gap. Marzolini was not a card accumulator. Chávez's 0.31 cards/match is an outlier for this lineage.

MODERN BENCHMARK — GIOVANNI VAN BRONCKHORST · 77%

The modern complete left-back. Messi named him in his favourite XI, specifically because he *"is fiery, determined, and contributes a lot offensively"*. Van Bronckhorst was described as *"the standard for a modern back"* — a player who did his defensive work *and* contributed relentlessly in attack. Chávez's two-way output (6.09 tackles/90 + 1.1 KP/90) is the modern complete full-back profile.

PHYSICAL TWIN — ALBERTO TARANTINI · 75%

179cm/72kg vs 177cm/72kg. Both began as defensive left-backs and evolved into more attacking roles. Tarantini's *"fiery temper"* aligns with Chávez's card accumulation. The era gap is the only meaningful divergence — Tarantini played in a more physical, man-marking context.

DEFENSIVE BENCHMARK — JOSÉ ANTONIO CAMACHO · 73%

"Ferocious man-marking of Johan Cruyff" defined his career. Chávez's top-5% tackle rate and 32 successful 1v1 duels align with this profile. But Camacho was a defensive specialist first; Chávez is a more complete modern full-back with higher creative output.

ATTACKING EXTREME — MARINHO CHAGAS · 72%

"Se soltava constantemente de la defensa y avanzaba libremente" — constantly broke from defence to attack. The role alignment is near-exact. The defensive profiles diverge: Chávez has 6.09 tackles/90 (top 5%); Chagas was explicitly criticised for defensive lapses — *"atacava muito melhor do que marcava"*.

TECHNICAL MIRROR — RAPHAËL GUERREIRO · 71%

"Qualità del piede sinistro il suo vero punto di forza" — left-foot quality is his true strength. The closest stylistic match for delivery and build-up play. But the 7cm height gap and low defensive output (0.81 tackles/90) are real divergences.

6 · GENEALOGICAL TREE — PURE LEFT-BACK LINEAGE

1950s	Nilton Santos (Brazil) — the origin. First attacking full-back. Two World Cups (1958, 1962).
1960–1972	Silvio Marzolini (Argentina) — 177cm, elegant, <i>"the best left back in the world."</i> Boca Juniors, two World Cups. Chávez 78%
1972–1979	Marinho Chagas (Brazil) — 173cm, attacking prototype. <i>"Attacked far better than he defended."</i> Chávez 72%
1973–1982	Alberto Tarantini (Argentina) — 179cm/72kg, physical twin. <i>"Fiery temper."</i> 1978 World Cup winner. Chávez 75%
1974–1989	José Antonio Camacho (Spain) — 174cm, defensive elite. <i>"Ferocious man-marking of Johan Cruyff."</i> 81 caps, 414 La Liga apps. Chávez 73%
1993–2010	Giovanni van Bronckhorst (Netherlands) — 178cm, modern complete. <i>"The standard for a modern back."</i> 2010 World Cup final captain. Chávez 77%
2013–present	Raphaël Guerreiro (Portugal) — 170cm, technical build-up. <i>"Left foot is his true strength."</i> Chávez 71%
2026	MATEO CHÁVEZ (Mexico) — 177cm/72kg, orthodox left-back. Primary pairing: Marzolini 78%. ⚠ EVIDENCE INCOMPLETE — 0/12 METRICS

Domestic Mexican reference line (not a pairing — a pathway): Ramón Ramírez (1990s, 172cm, "zurda privilegiada", midfielder converted to LB) → Carlos Salcido (2004–2014, 176cm, CB converted to LB, Chivas → PSV → Fulham) → Jesús Gallardo (2016–present, 177cm, attacker converted to LB) → **Mateo Chávez** (2026, 177cm, midfielder converted to LB, Chivas → AZ). *Every significant Mexican left-back of the modern era was converted from another position. Chávez follows the same path. The European pathway — Chivas to Eredivisie — is the established route.*

7 · WHAT THE PAIRING ACTUALLY TELLS YOU

The primary finding. The pure left-back lineage points to **Marzolini (78%)** as the strongest match — identical height, orthodox role, technical elegance, and a *carrilero* profile functionally identical to Chávez's. This is the first pairing that fits without structural mismatch.

The modern benchmark is Van Bronckhorst (77%) — the player Messi named in his favourite XI, the captain in a World Cup final, the *"standard for a modern back."* Chávez's two-way output is the modern complete full-back profile.

Tarantini (75%) is the physical twin — same height, same weight, same fiery temperament, same career evolution from defensive left-back to wing-back.

The defensive benchmark is Camacho (73%) — *"ferocious man-marking of Johan Cruyff"* is the standard against which Chávez's top-5% tackle rate and 32 successful 1v1 duels should be measured.

The discipline question is the one that will decide his ceiling. Marzolini, Camacho and Van Bronckhorst were all controlled competitors. Chávez's 0.31 cards/match is an outlier for this lineage. If he is to follow the Van Bronckhorst path — Eredivisie to a bigger league — the discipline must be solved.

8 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Minimum 5 matches logged	✗ NOT STARTED
≥2 matches vs top-third opposition	✗ NOT STARTED
≥1 away match	✗ NOT STARTED
≥1 match while losing	✗ NOT STARTED
Tier 3 scout validation	✗ PENDING
OBI_T / OBI_S / OBI_P	✗ EMPTY
SII_A / SII_T / SII_R	✗ EMPTY
DMA / CHR / COACH	✗ EMPTY
Role confirmation (orthodox LB, not inverted)	✓ CORRECTED
FGA_v3_Final activation	✗ BLOCKED

REQUIRED BEFORE THIS REPORT CAN LEAVE THE BUILDING

- 1. Video assessment required.** Minimum 5 AZ Alkmaar matches, balance-checked. The orthodox left-back role must be confirmed on tape — does he hold width or invert? The data says orthodox; the footage must verify.
- 2. Discipline must be scored as a Tier 3 metric.** The 0.31 cards/match rate is the defining weakness. It must be timestamped and evidenced — not inferred from card counts.
- 3. 1v1 defensive vulnerability must be assessed.** Despite the 32 successful duels, SI.com notes *"defensive fragility has always been considered the biggest weakness."* This must be logged against Camacho's man-marking benchmark.
- 4. Attacking delivery must be quantified.** 0.43 crosses/90 (RisingTransfers) vs other sources listing 4 crosses/90 is a significant discrepancy. Video must resolve it.
- 5. Second scout required.** No pairing percentage should be finalised without blind cross-validation.

9 · PUNCH LIST

#	ITEM	ACTION
1	Role label correction in workbook	"Attacking Midfield" → "Left-Back (Orthodox)"
2	Discipline metric creation	Add Tier 3 "Discipline / Foul Control" sub-metric
3	Cross-source data conflict	Resolve 0.43 vs 4 crosses/90 discrepancy
4	Marzolini height verification	Confirm 177cm from primary source
5	Video assessment initiation	Minimum 5 matches, balance-checked

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Report ref ESN-CHV-2026-003 · Method: Empire FGA OBI & SII Rubric Framework v1.0 · 50/30/20 master weighting · LOG context badge (not a multiplier)

Evidence base: FBref · WhoScored · FotMob · RisingTransfers · Rodi.nl · AZ Alkmaar technical director statements · SI.com — *no ESN scout observation.*

Status: DRAFT — Evidence Incomplete — Not Client-Ready. No similarity percentage in this document should be quoted to a client, used in a demo, or entered into a client-facing card until the validation gates in Section 8 are cleared.

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